

offer your services to. By working for them, you can eventually ask for an introduction to the CTO and get your foot in the door. Now that everybody has work to toot about, let's turn our attention to the finer points.

Portfolio hosting site or own website

There are several websites you can use for showcasing your portfolio. You have dedicated portfolio hosting websites like Behance.com which can be leveraged as an effective marketing tool. There are also freelance portals like



There are several portfolio sites to choose from. You can also create different portfolio styles on different sites

Freelancer.com or Upwork.com. These let you upload your work creating a portfolio as well show you the current work available like a job portal. Then there are social media platforms like LinkedIn which has a portfolio section and you can also connect with potential clients to showcase your work.

You can also create your own website to showcase your talents. The benefit of creating a website is it can be used as project and part of your portfolio. Use your skills to make the website speak for you – as a writer or graphic artist or coder. Pour your heart out into the website and proudly tout it as one of your best accomplishments. Update it as you upgrade your skills.

Bagging the first client

The litmus test. And of course easier said than done. You will be tempted to put up your profile and portfolio on freelancing websites and get that overseas project that can pay really big bucks. But refrain yourself. The easiest way to get the first paying client and project is to go local. Talk to friends, family, ex colleagues, people willing to help you out. You can land your first through these connections. Approaching local businesses using social media like Facebook and LinkedIn can also work. There are several facebook pages dedicated to small scale businesses and startups and many of their members post their requirements on the page. They can vary from funding to employees and includes a need for freelancers.